4.6 Acute Pulmonary Edema

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "I am drowning." **Objective** • Pink frothy sputum • Crackles all through the lungs • SpO_2 84%, RR 36/min	**ACTUAL** **Impaired gas exchange** related to fluid in alveoli as evidenced by hypoxemia, frothy sputum and crackles.	SpO_2 94% or more within 1 hour.	• Sit him bolt upright with his legs hanging down. • Give high-flow oxygen and be ready for CPAP as ordered. • Give the IV diuretic and nitrates as prescribed. • Continuous monitoring of SpO_2, BP and ECG. • If ordered, put in a urinary catheter to measure output.	SpO_2 on target, less breathless: **goal met**.
Subjective • Very frightened **Objective** • Agitated • Sweaty	**ACTUAL** **Anxiety** related to severe breathlessness as evidenced by agitation and fear.	Looks calmer as his breathing settles.	• Stay with him. • Speak calmly and tell him what you are doing. • Give the prescribed medication.	Calmer: **goal met**.
Subjective • *No specific complaint* **Objective** • On high-dose • IV diuretic	**RISK** **Risk for electrolyte imbalance** as evidenced by risk factors: rapid diuresis.	Potassium and sodium stay normal during the diuresis.	• Check potassium and sodium as ordered. • Watch the ECG for dysrhythmia. • Replace potassium as ordered. • While the IV diuretic is running, record urine output every hour.	Electrolytes normal: **goal met**.